

Asignatura

Inglés Profesional

Reported Speech



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Instituto Superior de FP

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Direct vs. Indirect Speech

Differences

El estilo **indirecto** (conocido como “**reported**” en inglés) se usa para contar lo que otra persona ha dicho anteriormente, pero, **sin reproducir sus palabras exactas**

Ex: *She said that she would buy a new car the following year.*

Por el contrario, el estilo **directo** es aquel en el que **reproducimos las palabras literales** de alguien usando **comillas** (quotation marks).

Ex: *She said: “I will buy a new car next year”.*



Verb tense changes: Backshift

1. Reporting verbs

Cuando pasamos de estilo directo a reported el verbo de la oración original normalmente da un **salto atrás en el pasado** para reflejar el contexto.

Este fenómeno se conoce como “**backshift**” y solo ocurre cuando el **reporting verb** está en pasado. Pero ¿qué es un reporting verb?



Verb tense changes: Backshift

1. Reporting verbs

Los **reporting verbs** son verbos que se usan para **introducir el estilo indirecto**, ya que nos **indican la manera** en la que alguien dijo algo, por ejemplo: *state, ask, explain, claim, tell, say*, etc; o también lo que hizo mientras hablaba, por ejemplo: *promise, warn, suggest*.

Como ya hemos mencionado, si el reporting verb está conjugado en pasado, el verbo del estilo directo da un salto al pasado.



Verb tense changes: Backshift

En la siguiente tabla se muestran los cambios que comprende el fenómeno "backshift".

Backshift	Examples
Present Simple → Past Simple	She said, "I like my new phone." → She said that she liked her new phone.
Present Continuous → Past Continuous	She said, "I'm using my phone." → She said that she was using her phone.
Present Perfect → Past Perfect	She said, "I've used my phone." → She said that she had used her phone.
Past Simple → Past Perfect	She said, "I used my phone." → She said that she had used her phone.
Past Continuous → Past Perfect Continuous	She said, "I was using my phone." → She said that she had been using her phone.
Past Perfect → Past Perfect	She said, "I had used my phone." → She said that she had used her phone.
Future Simple → Conditional Simple	She said, "I will use my phone." → She said that she would use her phone.
Future Perfect → Conditional Perfect	She said, "I will have used my phone." → She said that she would have used her phone.



Verb tense changes: Backshift

En la siguiente tabla se muestran los cambios que comprende el fenómeno "backshift" en los **verbos modales**.

Backshift	Examples
Can → Could	He said "I can speak five languages" → He said that he could speak five languages.
Have to → Had to	She said, "I have to work tomorrow" → She said that she had to work the following day.
Must → Had to	They said, "We must study more" → They said that they had to study more.
May → Might	Sarah said, "It may rain tomorrow" → Sarah said that it might rain the following day.



Backshift in questions

Cuando queremos usar el reported speech en **preguntas**, se aplica el backshift, pero también **hay que cambiar el orden de las palabras** (pasar de estructura de pregunta a estructura de afirmación).

- **With yes/no questions:** we use "**if**" or "**whether**", for example:
 - Direct speech: He asked, "Did she call?"
 - Reported speech: He asked if she had called.
- **With Wh-questions:** we **keep the wh-word** and change the verb tense, for example:
 - Direct speech: She asked me, "Where do you live?"
 - Reported speech: He asked me where I lived.

Other changes: pronouns



Subject pronouns changes

Es necesario cambiar el pronombre de sujeto (*I, you, he she, it, we, they*) en función de quién está reportando el discurso. Por ejemplo:

He said: "**I** am tired." → He said that **he** was tired.

She said: "**We** love technology." → She said that **they** loved technology.

They said: "**You** are late." → They said that **I** was late.

Object pronouns changes

Los pronombres de objeto (*me, you, him, her, us, them*) también deben cambiar dependiendo del contexto para ajustarse a la nueva forma de hablar.

She said: "He helped **me**." → She said that he had helped **her**.

He told me: "I will call **you**." → He said that he would call **me**.



Other changes: pronouns



Possessive pronouns changes

Los pronombres posesivos (*mine, yours, his, hers, ours, theirs*), así como los adjetivos posesivos (*my, your, his, her, our, their*) también deben cambiar para mantener la coherencia y cohesión.

She said: "This is **my** phone." → She said that that was **her** phone.

He said: "These **tablets** are ours." → He said that those tablets were **theirs**.

Reflexive pronouns changes

Los pronombres reflexivos (*myself, yourself, himself, herself, itself, ourselves, yourselves, themselves*) siguen la misma lógica.

She said: "I hurt **myself**." → She said that she had hurt **herself**.

He said: "You should take care of **yourself**." → He said that I should take care of **myself**.



Other changes: reporting commands and requests



For **commands**, we use the structure **told + (not) to + verb (infinitive)**.

For example:

"Close the door!" → She told me to close the door.

"Don't touch that!!" → He told me not to touch that.

For **requests**, we use the structure **asked + (not) to + verb (infinitive)**.

For example:

"Can you help me?" → She asked me to help her.

"Please don't go" → He asked me not to go.

Other changes: time expressions

Direct Speech	Reported Speech
Now	Then
Today	That day
Tonight	That night
Yesterday	The day before / The previous day
Tomorrow	The next day / The following day
Next (week, month, year...)	The following (week, month, year...)
Last (week, month, year...)	The previous (week, month, year...)
Ago	Before



Other changes: place expressions

Direct Speech	Reported Speech
Here	There
This	That
These	Those



The background is a solid blue color. Overlaid on this are several faint, light-blue geometric patterns. These include a grid of small squares that form larger, irregular shapes, and numerous small, light-blue arrows pointing in various directions. The overall effect is a sense of movement and digital connectivity.

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